

PITCH GUIDELINES:

Please read the draft guidelines below before writing your pitch. Send to edit@noemamag.com (or the editor you're in touch with) all of the following:

- ~at least 500 words — the longer the better. You have the best chance of being published if you send in a full draft upfront
- ~concise thesis up top, like in [this model pitch](#)
- ~rough word count you expect the full draft to be
- ~links to a few articles you've published elsewhere

DRAFT GUIDELINES:

Noema seeks original essays that have a clear, focused thesis and spend the length of the piece explaining and defending that thesis. To ensure that your essay is sharply organized around the thesis (and isn't trying to take on too much), please include subheadlines (three words, give or take) – we may decide to cut them, but having a sort of outline helps discipline the writer and editor. Our sweet spot for word count is between 2500-4000 words.

While we have many academic readers, we also have many non-academic readers so we encourage our writers to use voice and color to make their essays appeal to our wide audience. The first paragraph or few of the piece are the most important; they need to be colorful and alive – often with a vignette, usually involving a specific person – to draw in the reader. Include concrete examples and details throughout the piece, to avoid being too theoretical or vague. Real-world examples are preferable but if there aren't any, hypothetical examples are better than none. If you're writing about a problem, spend most of your time on the solution/s you propose, not the diagnosis — [this](#) is an especially good example (also [this](#), [this](#) and [this](#)). Also, stay away from posing questions unless you immediately answer them.

Assume your readers know nothing about the subject. Use layman's terms whenever possible. When you need to use jargon, make a historical reference, etc, then explain what it is. We prefer explanations within the text itself but, when needed, they can be footnoted. (Avoid relying on footnotes; [here's](#) an example of a piece that has about as many footnotes — in the right margin in blue — as we allow.) Please avoid long paragraphs, which make reading on mobile difficult — break them up instead. Hyperlink all factual references to reputable online sources in English (only hyperlink 1-2 words at a time). Also, we only publish original content so can't have any sentences be similar to previously published or soon-to-be-published writing of yours.

If you haven't written for a generalist, non-academic magazine much, you may not be aware that cuts are very common and an important part of the sharpening of a piece. The first few drafts of a piece almost always have some repetition or unnecessary information that isn't serving the piece. Recognizing those parts is the job of the editor, so please respect and trust their practiced skill at strengthening pieces. You'll be expected to respond to edit requests from your editor and to any questions our fact-checker may have, including providing any notes,

transcripts or audio to help with the process. If Noema chooses not to publish the piece, but it was written in a timely manner and in good faith, then we will pay a 25% kill fee.

We commission original artwork for most essays and features. We also like to include additional photos, images or videos within the text (scroll through this [example](#) to see several). Thus, we encourage writers to suggest photos or images that you think we should try to license for use; the images can be abstract and do not need to be mentioned in the text.

AI GUIDELINES:

Please include an AI statement in all pitches and drafts, specifying whether or not you used AI — including how, where and why you used it. Authors must disclose any and all use of AI to develop their pitches or draft submissions upfront, and Noema will consider allowing its use on a case-by-case basis. (To be clear, our preference is for original work created without the use of AI, and we do internal due diligence to assess its usage.) Unauthorized or undisclosed usage of AI, especially discovered after submission, however, will almost always result in an automatic decision to end our relationship with the writer, who will also forfeit any pre-discussed kill fee. Please note that unauthorized or undisclosed use of AI can also result in the loss of any indemnification as outlined in our contract. Noema may request recordings, transcripts, notes or any other primary documentation to ensure accuracy during the fact-checking process. See our full [policy here](#).